



Finger Play

Requirements

1. Listen to a story about hands
2. Say three things you learned about hands.
3. Say a poem and use your hand to act it out.
4. Make a craft that uses your hands as part of the project. (i.e., finger-paint, trace hands).
5. Complete an activity using your fingers. (i.e., build something with blocks, knead bread)

Supporting Answers

1. There are many different tactics/purposes that you can use this requirement for. If your goal is to applaud handwashing, for example, you could use the storyjumper.com online book story (<http://www.storyjumper.com/book/index/6307852/Hand-Washing>) or use your favorite search engine to find “kids hand washing story.”

A discussion about hands could take place just before or even while the children make a craft (#4). Discuss with the children about what their hands are doing (coloring, painting, fingers moving, fingers touching, hand grabbing etc.). Ask them what other things hands help them do (clap, wave, play piano, hug etc.) You can also use this opportunity to help the children count their fingers, observe how there are hard nails, soft skin, and strong muscles in their hands. They can also compare their hands with those of another child or of an adult (smaller, bigger, lighter, darker, long fingers, short fingers etc.)

2. Give each adult a card with one facts about fingers and hands on it. Have children “walk run” from one adult to another (the adults are sitting/kneeling in different parts of the room) and “collect” the facts about fingers and hands. Each time they can tell a different adult something they learned they get a “high five” (adult and child each use a hand to touch the others hand, palms facing. It is much like a clap).

Some simple finger facts:

We have four fingers and an opposable (say op-oh-zab-el) thumb. Opposable means that it can move towards the fingers and help them to do their work.

Each finger has 3 bones and the thumb has two bones

There are 27 bones in the hand

Doctors call fingers digits or phalanges

There are 2 main sets of muscles and tendons. Flexor muscles bend the fingers and thumb, and extensors straighten them out again.

3. Finger Play is an often-used early childhood education method to help kids memorize poems, Bible verses, and songs. It works so well because they are